GOVERNMENT OF INDIA

Ministry of Education · Department of Higher Education

Ref. No. DHE/NMS/2025/01
Dated: 18 March 2025

National Merit Scholarship Scheme — Guidelines 2025

Effective from 1 April 2025

1. Introduction

1.1 Objective

The National Merit Scholarship Scheme provides financial assistance to meritorious students from economically weaker families to pursue full-time undergraduate studies at recognised institutions.

2. Eligibility Criteria

2.1 Income Criteria

The annual family income of the applicant from all sources must not exceed ₹2,00,000 (Rupees Two Lakh) per annum. Income shall be certified by a competent revenue authority not below the rank of Tehsildar.

2.2 Academic Criteria

The applicant must have secured at least 60% aggregate marks in the qualifying examination (Class XII or equivalent).

2.3 Age Limit

The applicant must be between 17 and 25 years of age as on 1 July 2025.

2.4 Mode of Study

The applicant must be enrolled in a full-time undergraduate programme at a recognised institution.

2.5 Other Scholarships

Students already receiving any other central or state government scholarship are not eligible.

3. Scholarship Benefits

3.1 Tuition Fee

Tuition fee reimbursement of up to ₹40,000 per academic year is paid directly to the institution.

3.2 Maintenance Allowance

A maintenance allowance of ₹1,200 per month is paid to the student for ten months in an academic year.

3.3 Exclusions

The scholarship does not cover examination fees, which remain the responsibility of the student.

4. Application Process

4.1 Mode of Application

Applications may be submitted online through the National Scholarship Portal or in physical form at the institution.

4.2 Last Date

The last date for submission of applications is 31 August 2025.

4.3 Documents

Applicants must upload the documents listed in the Application Requirements notified by the Department.

5. Renewal

The scholarship is renewable annually, provided the student secures at least 55% marks in the previous year's examination and maintains a minimum attendance of 75%.

6. Disbursement

The scholarship amount is credited to the student's bank account.

Any amount found to have been obtained on the basis of false information shall be recovered in full.